PRACTITIONER PROTOCOL

Hot Stone Massage

Follow your heater manufacturer's instructions and state board rules. Times are for 75 min.

SCREEN

Intake cleared. Neuropathy, poor circulation, heat sensitivity: no stones or modify.

HEAT CHECK

Thermometer in heater, about 120–130°F [per manufacturer]. Forearm test each stone.

PRE-SESSION

Heater on [45–60] min ahead, stones covered with water. Stones inspected for cracks.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Hands washed ☐ Fresh linens, barrier sheet ☐ Calibrated thermometer ☐ Slotted spoon, no bare-hand dipping ☐ Cool water and towels ☐ Nut-free oil option

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Screen & consent**	5 min	Review health changes, medications and skin. Agree heat and pressure.
2	**Log temperature**	2 min	Read the thermometer and log it. Too hot: add cool water, wait, recheck.
3	**Forearm test**	Each stone	Hold on your inner forearm several seconds before it touches the client.
4	**Placed stones**	5 min	On top of the sheet or a towel only. Never under the body on bare skin.
5	**Warm up**	8 min	Hands-on effleurage with oil first, then bring in stones while moving.
6	**Back & shoulders**	20 min	Stones glide with oil and keep moving. Swap stones as they cool.
7	**Legs & feet**	12 min	Gliding strokes. Avoid varicose veins and the back of the knee.
8	**Turn & front**	15 min	Remove placed stones first. Arms, legs, gentle neck; no anterior neck.
9	**Check in**	Throughout	Ask about heat at each new stone and area. Lift at once if too hot.
10	**Remove & skin check**	3 min	Count all stones out. Look for redness that doesn't fade or blistering.
11	**Aftercare & rebook**	5 min	Water offered, rise slowly. Review the card. Log end temperature.

ENDPOINT AND SAFETY

- Stones always moving unless placed over a barrier
- Wash with soap and water, then disinfect per label
- Count stones in and out of the heater
- Drain and clean heater daily; retire cracked stones

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Stone too hot: lift at once, set it aside and check the skin.
- Large, deep or facial burn: seek medical care. Note it on the record.
- Heater over temperature: unplug, add cool water, recheck before use.
- Burn or blister: cool running water 20 minutes. Don't pop or cover tightly.
- Overheated or lightheaded: remove stones, cool cloth, water, sit slowly.
- Cracked or chipped stone: remove from service right away.

Always write an incident report and check in with the client within 24 to 48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

Temp start · time	Temp mid · time	Temp end · time	Forearm test done
Barrier for placements	**Stones counted out**	**Skin after · reaction**	**Next visit · initials**